Vincent van Gogh

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

INSTRUCTIONS

Read about the artist. Answer the questions in full sentences. Then complete the drawing task at the bottom.

MEET THE ARTIST

Vincent van Gogh was born in the Netherlands in 1853. He did not become an artist until he was 27, and he painted for only about ten years, but in that time he made almost 900 paintings. He loved bright colours and used thick paint, laying it on with swirling brushstrokes so you can see every mark. His most famous pictures include **Sunflowers**, a series of vases of yellow flowers, and The Starry Night, a swirling sky over a small town with a huge dark cypress tree. Van Gogh wrote hundreds of letters to his brother Theo about his ideas and his paintings. He sold very little of his work during his life, but today he is one of the most famous painters in the world.

QUESTIONS

1. In which country was Vincent van Gogh born?

_____

2. How old was he when he became an artist, and for about how many years did he paint?

_____

3. Describe two things about the way he used paint.

_____

4. Name two of his famous paintings.

_____

5. Who did he write hundreds of letters to?

_____

YOUR TURN

Draw a night sky over your town in Van Gogh's style: short, curved, swirling strokes of colour, and a big dark tree or building in front.

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Vincent van Gogh - Answer key

1. The Netherlands.

2. 27 years old; he painted for about ten years.

3. He used bright colours and thick paint with swirling brushstrokes (visible marks).

4. Sunflowers and The Starry Night.

5. His brother Theo.

YOUR TURN:

Drawing task; no single answer.

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